



Community Grants Program

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

General Questions

1. What is the Community Grants Program?

The Community Grants Program provides financial support to eligible individuals, community groups, businesses, and organizations to implement projects that contribute to community development, economic empowerment, social inclusion, innovation, and environmental sustainability.

2. Who manages the Community Grants Program?

The program is administered by the Community Grants Secretariat and overseen by the Community Grants Management.

3. What types of grants are available?

The program currently offers:

- Informal, Micro Enterprise Grants
- MSME Grants
- Community Action Grants
- Innovation Grants
- Special Projects Grants

4. Is there an application fee?

No. Applications are submitted free of charge.

5. How often are grant rounds conducted?

Grant rounds are announced periodically, subject to funding availability and approved schedules.

Eligibility Questions

6. Who can apply?

Eligible applicants may include:

- Individuals

- Informal vendors
- Women's groups
- Youth groups
- Community-based organizations
- Registered MSMEs
- Cooperatives
- NGOs and CSOs
- Community alliances

7. Can a newly established business apply?

Yes, depending on the grant category and eligibility requirements.

8. Can government employees apply?

Government employees may apply in their personal capacity if they meet eligibility requirements and are not involved in grant decision-making.

9. Can I submit more than one application?

Applicants may only submit one application per grant round unless otherwise stated in the guidelines.

10. Can previous grant recipients apply again?

Yes, provided previous grants were satisfactorily completed and acquitted.

Application Process

11. How do I apply?

Applicants must complete the official application form and submit all required supporting documents before the deadline.

12. Where can I obtain an application form?

Application forms are available through the Community Grants Secretariat, district offices, ward offices, or official program channels.

13. Can I submit my application electronically?

Where available, applications may be submitted online or by email. Refer to the grant announcement for submission options.

14. What happens if my application is incomplete?

Incomplete applications may be rejected or returned for clarification.

15. Can I update my application after submission?

Only before the application deadline and subject to approval by the Grant Management.

Funding Questions

16. How much funding can I apply for?

Funding depends on the grant category:

- Micro Enterprise Grants: Up to K5,000
- MSME Grants: K5,001 – K7,000
- Community Action Grants: K7,001 – K10,000
- Innovation Grants: K10,001 – K50,000
- Special Projects Grants: K50,001 – K100,000

17. Do I have to contribute my own funds?

Some grant categories may encourage co-contributions or partnerships.

18. Is the grant a loan?

No. Grants do not require repayment provided funds are used for approved purposes and reporting requirements are met.

19. Will all applicants receive funding?

No. Funding is competitive and subject to assessment and available budget.

Assessment and Selection

20. How are applications assessed?

Applications are assessed against criteria such as:

- Eligibility
- Community impact
- Feasibility
- Sustainability
- Inclusion and gender considerations
- Financial value for money
- Alignment with program priorities

21. Who decides which applications are approved?

The Community Grants Review Panel evaluates applications and makes recommendations for approval.

22. How long does assessment take?

Assessment timelines vary depending on application volume and grant category.

23. Can I appeal a decision?

Applicants may submit a request for review where an appeal process exists under program guidelines.

24. Will I receive feedback if unsuccessful?

General feedback may be provided where resources permit.

Grant Management

25. When will successful applicants receive funding?

Funding is normally released after signing a grant agreement and satisfying all pre-disbursement requirements.

26. What can grant funds be used for?

Funds must only be used for approved project activities and budget items.

27. What cannot be funded?

Generally, grants cannot be used for:

- Personal expenses
- Debt repayment
- Political activities
- Illegal activities
- Religious campaigning
- Activities outside approved project objectives

28. Can I change my project after approval?

Any significant changes require prior written approval from the Grant Management.

Reporting and Accountability

29. Do grant recipients need to report on activities?

Yes. All recipients must provide progress and completion reports.

30. Will financial reports be required?

Yes. Recipients must provide evidence of expenditure and acquittal documentation.

31. Can the program inspect funded projects?

Yes. Monitoring visits and audits may be conducted at any time.

32. What happens if funds are misused?

Misuse of funds may result in:

- Repayment requirements
 - Cancellation of funding
 - Disqualification from future grants
 - Legal action where applicable
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Transparency and Integrity

33. How does the program prevent favoritism?

All applications are assessed using transparent criteria and conflict-of-interest procedures.

34. What if I suspect fraud or corruption?

Concerns should be reported immediately to the Community Grants Secretariat through official reporting channels.

35. Is my information confidential?

Yes. Applicant information is managed in accordance with confidentiality and privacy requirements.

Contact Information

36. Who can I contact for assistance?

Community Grants Secretariat

Phone: 324 0700 / 324 0644

Email: CommunityG@ncdc.gov.pg